

Jaisalmer Gold, following the success of Jaisalmer Black, is another exceptional product. It contains 18 botanicals, including saffron, used for the first time in this context. This gives Jaisalmer Gold a distinctive and luxurious flavor profile.

- **So how do your products compare to their competitors in terms of quality and market positioning?**

We do not claim a specific age for our products, but our pricing reflects the superior quality and craftsmanship that goes into each bottle. For instance, Rampur Double Cask is priced at around 8,500 INR, which places it in the same bracket as 12- to 18-year-old whiskies from other brands. The original Rampur Select is positioned in the price range of a Glenfiddich 18-year-old. Our Jugalbandi series, on the other hand, is priced at double that of the 18-year-old Glenfiddich, underscoring our confidence in the exceptional quality and uniqueness of our offerings.

- **In an industry where direct advertising is not possible, what innovative strategies have you implemented to create awareness around your brands?**

We've implemented several innovative strategies to build our brands in an industry where direct advertising is restricted. Firstly, we focus heavily on point-of-sale marketing. This includes extensive shop branding and creative displays, ensuring that the consumer's interaction with our products at the purchase point is engaging and memorable.

Secondly, digital marketing is a significant part of our strategy. At Radico, we pride ourselves on being a young and dynamic company. Over the past two decades, we've successfully created 15 premium brands. Our target audience is young consumers, with around 15 million new consumers entering the drinking age bracket every year. We don't aim to change the habits of older consumers but to attract younger ones, making digital marketing crucial for us.

Furthermore, in India, Cricket and Bollywood are immensely popular, and we've leveraged this in our marketing efforts. Bollywood music, in particular, has been a cornerstone of our campaigns. We also engage in innovative on-premises marketing and sponsorships. For example, we've sponsored events like the Royal Ranthambore Golf Tournament, among other sporting events, to connect with our audience in unique and engaging ways.

- **How do regional preferences and cultural nuances impact your product offerings and marketing strategies?**

Regional preferences and cultural nuances play a significant role in shaping our product offerings and marketing strategies. India is a diverse country with 28 states, each having its unique drinking culture and preferences. For instance, 20% of the alcohol consumed in India is brandy, and 95% of this consumption is concentrated in the five southern states. This regional preference necessitates tailored marketing strategies.

At Radico, we adopt a philosophy of "think global, act regional." We create our brand communication on a global scale and then adapt it to fit regional contexts. You won't see luxury brands like ours engaging in typical advertising channels such as TV commercials. Instead, we ensure our products are present in the right places, reflecting their exclusivity. We are very cautious about where Rampur and Jaisalmer are sold, ensuring they maintain their premium image.

Responsible drinking is also becoming more prevalent. For example, Delhi has seen an exponential increase in pubs and bars. However, this growth has not led to an increase in negative incidents; on the contrary, they have come down, indicating a maturing drinking culture.

- **What is the core philosophy of Radico Khaitan?**

The core philosophy of Radico Khaitan revolves around creating value for our shareholders, expanding our reach, and investing strategically in our business, including our foray into the food industry. Our unique approach lies in organically developing brands that cater to a wide range of taste preferences. Unlike many companies that grow through acquisitions, we have built our capabilities from the ground up.

Also, being a proud Indian company is at the very core of our philosophy and strategy. We recently launched 'Spirit Of Victory 1999 Pure Malt' this year as a tribute to the war heroes of 1999 Kargil War, to commemorate the 25th anniversary of Kargil Vijay Diwas. With this product we created a new category of Pure Malt in the luxury brown spirits space. One of my key philosophies as a promoter is to foster a professional environment that encourages innovation and risk-taking. I believe in empowering our people, automating processes, and ensuring that the organization can thrive independently of any single individual. This approach has allowed us to develop a highly capable and motivated team.

Moreover, we have made our top executives stakeholders in the company through ESOPs (Employee Stock Ownership Plans). This strategy